

SPEAKING A2 – TOPIC 9: *TOURIST ATTRACTION*

PART 1: INTERVIEW

1. What's your name? Can I see your ID?
2. Where are you from?
3. Do you prefer travelling alone or in a group?
4. When you visit new places, what do you like to do?
5. What places would you like to visit in the future?

PART 2: LONG TURN

Describe a popular natural tourist attraction in your country

You should say:

- *What the place is*
- *Where it is located*
- *What activities visitors can do there*

and explain why it is popular with tourists

You will have to talk about the topic for 2 to 3 minutes. You have one minute to think about what you're going to say. You can make some notes to help you if you wish.

PART 3: TWO-WAY DISCUSSION

1. Do you think tourism helps or harms the environment?
2. What can tourists do to reduce their negative impact on nature?
3. Do you think governments should limit the number of tourists in some places?
4. What is more important: preserving nature or developing tourism?

SUGGESTIONS

PART 1: INTERVIEW

⇒ *Suggested answers:*

3. Do you prefer travelling alone or in a group?

- *I prefer travelling in a group because it's more fun. I can talk, laugh, and share good moments with my friends. It also feels safer when we go to new places.*
- *I like travelling alone because I can do what I want and move at my own speed. Sometimes I need time for myself to relax and think.*
- *It depends on the trip. If it's a short trip, I go with friends. But if I want to relax, I go alone.*

4. When you visit new places, what do you like to do?

- *When I visit new places, I like to take photos and try local food. I also enjoy walking around to see the sights and talk to local people.*
- *I like to go to the beach or the mountains to enjoy nature. I often take pictures and watch the sunset.*

5. What places would you like to visit in the future?

I want to visit Japan one day. I love its culture and food, and I want to see the cherry blossoms.

PART 2: LONG TURN

1. Selection

This can be a difficult topic if you select the wrong photo. An easy option is a holiday photo – then you can describe some aspects of the holiday.

2. Grammar Point

Use mostly present tenses.

3. Uncommon Vocabulary

Nouns	Meaning	Example
natural wonder	kỳ quan thiên nhiên	<i>Ha Long Bay is one of the natural wonders of the world.</i>
scenic spot	địa điểm có cảnh đẹp	<i>Ninh Binh is a scenic spot that attracts many local and international visitors.</i>
landscape	phong cảnh, cảnh quan	<i>The landscape around Fansipan Mountain is breathtaking.</i>
viewpoint	điểm ngắm cảnh	<i>There's a beautiful viewpoint where you can see the whole bay.</i>
hiking trail	đường mòn leo núi	<i>The hiking trail to the top is surrounded by lush forests.</i>

Nouns	Meaning	Example
waterfall	thác nước	<i>Ban Gioc Waterfall is one of the most magnificent in Southeast Asia.</i>
tourist trap	điểm du lịch thương mại hóa	<i>Some souvenir markets near the site are quite tourist traps.</i>
ecotourism	du lịch sinh thái	<i>Ecotourism is becoming increasingly popular in national parks.</i>

Verbs	Meaning	Example
go backpacking	đi du lịch bụi	<i>Some young travelers go backpacking through the mountains.</i>
explore	khám phá	<i>We spent two days exploring the caves in Phong Nha–Ke Bang.</i>
admire	chiêm ngưỡng	<i>Visitors can admire the crystal-clear water and limestone cliffs.</i>
preserve	bảo tồn	<i>Local authorities are trying to preserve the natural environment.</i>
rough it	sống thiếu tiện nghi	<i>When we stayed in the national park, we had to rough it for a few days.</i>
take a boat trip	đi du thuyền	<i>You can take a boat trip to explore the limestone islands.</i>
go sightseeing	đi tham quan	<i>Many tourists go sightseeing around Ha Long Bay by boat.</i>
go hiking / trekking	đi bộ đường dài	<i>Tourists love to go hiking along the mountain trails.</i>
enjoy the sunrise / sunset	ngắm bình minh / hoàng hôn	<i>Tourists often wake up early to enjoy the sunrise over the sea.</i>
stay overnight	ở lại qua đêm	<i>You can stay overnight in a homestay near the national park.</i>
capture the moment	ghi lại khoảnh khắc	<i>Many photographers try to capture the moment when the sun sets behind the cliffs.</i>

Adjectives	Meaning	Example
picturesque	đẹp như tranh vẽ	<i>The small village beside the lake looks picturesque.</i>
breathtaking	đẹp ngoạn mục, nín thở	<i>The view from the top of the mountain is simply breathtaking.</i>

Adjectives	Meaning	Example
lush	xanh tươi, rậm rạp	<i>The area is covered with lush tropical forests.</i>
peaceful	yên bình	<i>I love the peaceful atmosphere of the countryside.</i>
overdeveloped	bị phát triển quá mức	<i>Some coastal areas have become overdeveloped due to mass tourism.</i>
exclusive	độc quyền, cao cấp	<i>There are a few exclusive resorts near the beach.</i>
touristy	quá đông khách du lịch	<i>I prefer visiting hidden places rather than touristy spots.</i>

Idioms	Meaning	Example
off the beaten track	nơi ít người đến	<i>We found a quiet beach off the beaten track.</i>
see the sights	thăm các danh lam thắng cảnh	<i>We rented a bike to see the sights around the park.</i>
bring back memories	gợi lại kỷ niệm	<i>The trip brought back memories of my childhood holidays.</i>
do justice to (sth)	thể hiện đúng vẻ đẹp của...	<i>Photos can't do justice to how stunning the scenery really is.</i>
strike a pose	tạo dáng chụp ảnh	<i>Many visitors strike a pose in front of the waterfall.</i>

PART 3: TWO-WAY DISCUSSION

⇒ *Suggested answers*

1. Do you think tourism helps or harms the environment?

(Answer) *I think tourism mostly harms the environment.*

(Why) *When too many people visit the same place, they often leave rubbish, use a lot of water, and damage the natural area.*

(Example) *For example, some beaches and mountains in Vietnam have become dirty because of plastic waste from tourists.*

(Opposite) *On the other hand, tourism can also help the environment if people travel responsibly. Some tourist money is used to protect parks and support local communities.*

2. What can tourists do to reduce their negative impact on nature?

(Answer) *I think one good way for tourists to reduce their negative impact on nature is to avoid using plastic.*

(Why) *Plastic bottles and bags often end up in the ocean or forests, which can harm animals and pollute the environment.*

(Example) *As a solution, for example, tourists can bring reusable water bottles or cloth bags when they travel instead of buying plastic ones.*

(Opposite) *On the other hand, some people believe it's hard to travel without plastic, but with better planning, everyone can help keep nature clean.*

3. Do you think governments should limit the number of tourists in some places?

(Answer) *Yes, I think the government should limit the number of tourists in very crowded places.*

(Why) *Too many visitors can harm the environment, make the area dirty, and spoil the experience for others.*

(Example) *For instance, some beaches and islands in Vietnam were closed for cleaning because there were too many tourists before.*

(Opposite) *But limiting tourists can also reduce income for local people. So, the government should control tourism carefully, not stop it completely.*

4. What is more important: preserving nature or developing tourism?

(Answer) *I think preserving nature is more important than developing tourism.*

(Why) *Once natural places are destroyed, it's very hard to bring them back. Protecting the environment means protecting our future.*

(Example) *For example, if forests are cut down for hotels, animals will lose their homes, and tourists won't come anymore.*

(Opposite) *Still, I agree that tourism is important for the economy. We just need smart development that protects nature while supporting local people.*